

Literary Terms

Setting: the time period, location, and circumstances of the work.

Point of View: the narrative perspective from which a story is told. This may be 1st person, 3rd person limited, or 3rd person omniscient.

Characterization: the conveying of details about a character. This may be through descriptions, conversations, or the character's actions and thoughts said by the character or about that character by others.

Direct characterization: when the author directly states descriptions of the character's physical appearance or personality.

Indirect characterization: when the reader has to make inferences about the character based upon their behavior, words, or interactions with others or by what others say or do around that character.

Theme: the author's purpose or underlying meaning of a literary work. It is a message about life, love, or human nature. It is **not** a cliché or a moral. The theme is often used to create a thesis statement.

Foreshadowing: The use of hints or clues to suggest what will happen later in the story.

Imagery (also known as sensory details): language that appeals to the five senses.

Symbolism: the use of a person, place, or object to represent an abstract idea.

Conflict: a struggle between opposing forces.

Internal: within oneself

External: between two or more entities {this can include an individual or a society}

Plot Structure: the sequence of events that make up a story. The structure of a narrative is generally as follows: Exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.

Mood: the emotional atmosphere of the story.

Tone: expressed through the writer's attitude or feelings about the subject of the story.

Close Reading: For scholars, "close reading" is a mode of analysis—one of many possible modes, many of which can be used in conjunction with one another—that moves a reader beyond comprehension of the text to interpretation of the text.